

May 7, 2026

To whom it may concern,

My name is Kolbe Gillette. I am a teacher at Coalinga High School and I have been teaching for 5 years now. I had the pleasure of teaching Alexander Chi last year for AP World. Alexander is an exceptionally hard working student, adaptable, and is excited at the opportunity to work with others.

When I say that Alexander is a hard working student I'm sure you can imagine the kid who stays up late studying, and while Alexander is that kid, he is also so much more. This is the kid that runs to his next class so he can be on time and has more time to get work done. He asks questions in class and interacts well with teachers to confirm that he is understanding the right idea. In my AP World History class we covered the entire world's history from 1200 to the modern day, no easy task. But Alexander was not only up for the challenge but would come in early and be the last to leave asking me questions and summarizing the day's lesson confirming that he got everything he needed from it.

Something else I learned about Alexander last year while he was my student was that he is open to change and willing to learn from others. Historians have a unique way of writing that the AP Exam wants to see presented and this learning curve is incredibly difficult for most students. While Alexander struggled at first, as anyone would, I was surprised at how quickly he adapted his writing to fit the needs of AP.

Lastly I want to talk about how social Alexander is. This is a kid who is not afraid to go in front of the class and do a rap battle about famous historical figures. A kid who comes into my room everyday at lunch to hang out with his friends and play board games. A kid who welcomes anyone new to the group and is willing to work with anyone in class. I saw him bring joy and support to others in the class who were struggling under the immense pressure of AP.

In the teaching field we joke that "make sure your students are doing their work because one day they are going to be YOUR pilot." I know Alexander dreams of becoming a doctor. When his training is said and done, because he is a kid who is going to get what he wants, I know he is going to make a fine doctor one day, one that I would send my kids too if they were sick.

If you have any questions, comments, or request further information, please reach out to me at kgillette@chusd.org

Best Regards,
Kolbe Gillette